CHAPTER 7

THE STATE RESPONSE

COUNTER-INSURGENCY (COIN)

Insurgency is violence with political motives. Therefore, it cannot be defeated with either a merely military solution or a purely political solution. A successful counter-insurgency strategy encompasses a carrot and stick policy: a melange of aggressive offensive to eradicate insurgency coupled with talks and socio-economic development. Negotiations are also undertaken to alienate population and to address the demands with the local leadership (Gurmeet, 2008). Pakistan's counter-terrorism strategy was designed by the Pakistan Army with little or no civilian input. Pakistan military conducted about 24 major operations in the tribal areas of Pakistan as a part of counter-terrorism strategy from 2002 to 2017.

The military operations in the last 13 years had been usually interlaced with intermittent peace deals with different groups of Taliban operating in the tribal areas. Table 7.1 presents the chronology of military operations and peace deals.

The most important campaigns since 2001 include support for the US-led Operation 'Enduring Freedom' (2001–2); Operation 'Al-Mizan' (2002–6); Operation 'Zalzala' (2008); Operations 'Sherdil', 'Rah-e-Haq' and 'Rah-e-Rast' (2007–9) and Operation 'Zarb-e-Azb'.

Operation Rah-e-Nijat was started in 2009 against the TTP and its affiliated groups in South Waziristan. Pakistan employed the army, the Frontier Corps and the Frontier Constabulary and Frontier Police in these operations (Fair & Jones, 2009). In July 2002, Pakistani troops entered the Khyber Agency for the first time since Pakistan's independence in 1947.